

Exercise Imagery Evaluation



As you complete this evaluation, remember that imagery is more than just visualizing something in your mind's eye. Vivid images may include many senses, such as seeing, hearing, feeling, touching, and smelling. Vivid images also may include feeling emotions or moods.

In this exercise, you will read descriptions of general exercise situations. You are to imagine the situation and provide as much detail from your imagination as possible to make the image as real as you can. Then you will be asked to rate your imagery in seven areas:

- a. How vividly you *saw* or visualized the image.
- b. How clearly you *heard* the sounds.
- c. How vividly you *felt your body* movements during the activity.
- d. How clearly you were aware of your mood or *felt your emotions* of the situation.
- e. Whether you could see the image from *inside your body*.
- f. Whether you could see the image from *outside your body*.
- g. How well you could *control* the image.

After you read each description, think of a specific example of it—the skill, the people involved, the place, the time. Then close your eyes and try to imagine the situation as vividly as you can.

There are, of course, no right or wrong images. Use your imagery skills to create the most vivid and clear image that you can. After you have completed imagining each situation, rate your imagery skills using the following scales.

For items a–f:

- 1 = no image present
- 2 = not clear or vivid, but a recognizable image
- 3 = moderately clear and vivid image
- 4 = clear and vivid image
- 5 = extremely clear and vivid image

For item g:

- 1 = no control at all
- 2 = very hard to control
- 3 = moderate control of image
- 4 = good control of image
- 5 = complete control of image

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Practicing Alone

Select one specific activity such as running, weight training, cycling, or swimming. Now imagine yourself performing this activity at the place where you normally perform (gym, pool, fitness center, field, court) without anyone else present. Close your eyes for about one minute and try to see yourself at this place, hear the sounds, feel your body perform the movement, and be aware of your state of mind or mood. Try to see yourself from behind your eyes or from inside your body. Then, try to see yourself from outside your body, as if you were watching a video of yourself performing.

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. Rate how well you <i>saw</i> yourself doing the activity. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| b. Rate how well you <i>heard</i> the sounds of doing the activity. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| c. Rate how well you <i>felt yourself</i> making the movements. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| d. Rate how well you were aware of your <i>mood</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| e. Rate how well you were able to see the image from <i>inside your body</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| f. Rate how well you were able to see the image from <i>outside your body</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| g. Rate how well you <i>controlled</i> the image. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

Practicing With Others

You are doing the same activity, but now you are practicing the activity with others present. This time, however, you make a mistake that everyone notices. Close your eyes for about one minute to imagine making the error and the situation immediately afterward as vividly as you can. First, try to experience the feelings you have as you make the mistake. Then, quickly try to recreate the situation in your mind and imagine yourself correcting the mistake and performing perfectly. Try to see the image from behind your eyes or from inside your body as you correct the mistake. Next, try to see the image as if you were watching through a video camera as you correct the mistake.

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|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. Rate how well you <i>saw</i> yourself doing the activity. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| b. Rate how well you <i>heard</i> the sounds of doing the activity. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| c. Rate how well you <i>felt yourself</i> making the movements. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| d. Rate how well you were aware of your <i>mood</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| e. Rate how well you were able to see the image from <i>inside your body</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| f. Rate how well you were able to see the image from <i>outside your body</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| g. Rate how well you <i>controlled</i> the image. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

Recalling a Peak Exercise Experience

Recall one of your all-time best exercise experiences in which you felt confident and in control—in the zone. Close your eyes for about one minute and try to see yourself in that situation, feel your emotions, and recreate the experience. Imagine your performance and recreate the feelings you experienced, both mentally and physically, during that performance. Try to see the image from within yourself, and then try to imagine the situation from outside yourself.

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|--|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. Rate how well you <i>saw</i> yourself doing the activity. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| b. Rate how well you <i>heard</i> the sounds of doing the activity. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| c. Rate how well you <i>felt yourself</i> making the movements. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| d. Rate how well you were aware of your <i>mood</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| e. Rate how well you were able to see the image from <i>inside your body</i> . | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

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|---|-----------|
| f. Rate how well you were able to see the image from <i>outside your body</i> . | 1 2 3 4 5 |
| g. Rate how well you <i>controlled</i> the image. | 1 2 3 4 5 |

Scoring

Now determine your imagery scores and see what they mean. Sum the rating for each category and record them below.

Directions	Dimension	Score
Sum of <i>a</i> items	Visual	_____
Sum of <i>b</i> items	Auditory	_____
Sum of <i>c</i> items	Kinesthetic	_____
Sum of <i>d</i> items	Emotion	_____
Sum of <i>e</i> items	Internal perspective	_____
Sum of <i>f</i> items	External perspective	_____
Sum of <i>g</i> items	Controllability	_____

Interpret your scores in the visual, auditory, kinesthetic, emotion, and controllability categories based on the following scale: excellent (20–18), good (17–15), average (14–12), fair (11–8), and poor (7–4). All of these categories are important for imagery training, so do not just rely on your visual sense. Work to improve the others! Remember, it takes practice but you can increase your imagery ability. Good luck!

Source: Adapted from Martens, R. Imagery in Sport. Unpublished paper presented at the Medical and Scientific Conference on Elitism in Sport. 1982.